

D409

Health and Human Services Professional Field Experience

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A case worker at a community agency with a new downtown office receives a call from a housing partner confirming that a client is enrolled in the agency's program. The partner has a signed release for enrollment status only and asks, "While I have you, what's her mental health diagnosis?" The partner is a former colleague. What should the case worker share?

- A. Nothing at all, not even enrollment status
- B. Only the enrollment status covered by the release
- C. The full file, because they worked together before
- D. The diagnosis too, since the partner already has a release

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which request best meets the minimum-necessary standard?

- A. A billing clerk requests only the dates and service codes needed to submit a claim.
- B. A supervisor requests every client's full record to check one client's dates.
- C. A researcher requests full records without approval because the study is important.
- D. A coworker asks about a client's history out of concern.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

During a home visit in a simulated case, a worker who has served the neighborhood for five years notices bruises in different stages of healing on a 7-year-old's arms. The parent says he "falls a lot." The family recently moved from another county. What should the worker do?

- A. Question the child in detail to confirm abuse first.
- B. Contact the family's old county to ask about past concerns.
- C. Wait until there is proof before reporting.
- D. Report the suspicion to child protective services as required.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A mandated reporter is unsure whether an older adult's weight loss and unpaid bills mean neglect. What standard triggers the duty to report?

- A.** The older adult's permission
- B.** Reasonable suspicion of abuse or neglect
- C.** Proof beyond a reasonable doubt
- D.** A second worker's agreement

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A client, who recently finished a job-training program with the agency and works at a bakery, sends the worker a friend request on social media and invites her to a family barbecue. What is the most appropriate response?

- A.** Accept both, because the client has finished the program.
- B.** Politely decline both and explain the professional boundary.
- C.** Accept the friend request but skip the barbecue.
- D.** Ignore both without explanation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A client in a simulated food-assistance case, who is a single father of three and drives for a delivery app, tells the worker he is being evicted and asks what legal steps to take. The worker has a friend who is a lawyer. What should the worker do?

- A.** Ask the worker's lawyer friend to handle the case informally.
- B.** Explain the eviction laws and tell him what to file.
- C.** Tell him legal problems are not the agency's concern.
- D.** Refer him to a legal aid organization or tenant-rights service.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A 72-year-old client, who used to be a school principal and lives alone with a dog, understands the risks but declines a move to assisted living and prefers home services. There is no immediate danger. The worker believes assisted living is safer. What should the worker do?

- A. Ask her family to make the decision instead.
- B. Arrange the assisted living move anyway for her safety.
- C. Respect her choice and help arrange home services.
- D. Close her case because she refused the recommendation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In which situation may a worker act against a competent client's stated wishes?

- A. Any time the worker is sure of a better option
- B. The client chooses a cheaper apartment the worker dislikes.
- C. The client refuses a job-training referral.
- D. The client states a specific plan to seriously harm someone today.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

After a simulated intake at an agency that opened its second site this spring, a trainee drafts a case note. The client, a retired carpenter, arrived 40 minutes late. Which entry is most appropriate?

- A. "Client arrived at 10:40 for a 10:00 appointment. Stated, 'The bus never came.'"
- B. "Client seems unmotivated to change."
- C. "Retired carpenter, so probably used to setting his own hours."
- D. "Client was irresponsible and late."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which case note contains a judgment rather than an objective fact?

- A. "Client was hostile during the visit."
- B. "Visit lasted 30 minutes; food voucher given."
- C. "Client raised his voice and said, 'Leave me alone.'"
- D. "Client stated she has not eaten since yesterday."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A client, who enrolled in a parenting program last month and whose sister also attends, says she wants to stop coming because it conflicts with her new work schedule. She signed an intake agreement for 12 weeks. What should the worker do?

- A.** Drop her without discussing any options.
- B.** Ask her sister to convince her to stay.
- C.** Explain any effects of stopping, then respect her decision to withdraw.
- D.** Tell her the signed agreement requires her to finish all 12 weeks.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

During a planned budgeting session in a simulated case, a client who is a former truck driver says his power was shut off yesterday and he has no heat. It is 20 °F outside and he has a heart condition. The session agenda was set last week. What should the worker address first?

- A.** Finish the budget plan as scheduled.
- B.** Refer him to a job-training program to raise income.
- C.** Arrange emergency heat, shelter, or utility assistance today.
- D.** Schedule a follow-up next week to discuss utilities.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A case worker at a community agency ~~with a new downtown office~~ receives a call from a housing partner confirming that a client is enrolled in the agency's program. The partner has a signed release for enrollment status only and asks, "While I have you, what's her mental health diagnosis?" ~~The partner is a former colleague.~~ What should the case worker share?

Target word: what to disclose **Decides:** The release covers enrollment status only.

A	Absolute language	The signed release permits the limited disclosure.
B	Correct	Minimum necessary limits disclosure to the authorized purpose.
C	Camouflage	A past working relationship does not expand authorization.
D	Dropped element	Drops the scope limit on the release.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

Which request best meets the minimum-necessary standard?

Target word: reverse: pick the compliant request **Decides:** Only what the task needs.

A	Correct	Limits data to the task.
B	Inverted operation	Asks for far more than the task needs.
C	Confusion set	Research has its own authorization rules.
D	Adjacent category	Concern is not a work purpose.

3. Answer D Concept 2

During a home visit in a simulated case, a worker ~~who has served the neighborhood for five years~~ notices bruises in different stages of healing on a 7-year-old's arms. The parent says he "falls a lot." ~~The family recently moved from another county.~~ What should the worker do?

Target word: reporting duty **Decides:** Reasonable suspicion triggers reporting.

A	Adjacent category	Investigation belongs to child protective services.
B	Camouflage	Uses the move detail and delays the required report.
C	Absolute language	The standard is reasonable suspicion, not proof.
D	Correct	Bruises in different stages with a vague explanation meet reasonable suspicion.

4. Answer B Concept 2 • transfer

A mandated reporter is unsure whether an older adult's weight loss and unpaid bills mean neglect. What standard triggers the duty to report?

Target word: reverse: name the threshold **Decides:** Reasonable suspicion.

A	Dropped element	Consent is not required to make a mandated report.
B	Correct	Reporters do not need certainty.
C	Inverted operation	A criminal court standard, not a reporting threshold.
D	Confusion set	Consulting is fine, but it is not the legal trigger.

5. Answer B Concept 3

A client, ~~who recently finished a job training program with the agency and works at a bakery,~~ sends the worker a friend request on social media and invites her to a family barbecue. What is the most appropriate response?

Target word: boundary response **Decides:** Personal social contact creates a dual relationship.

A	Adjacent category	Former clients can still be harmed by dual relationships.
B	Correct	Keeps the relationship professional and respectful.
C	Dropped element	Social media contact is itself a boundary problem.
D	Inverted operation	Silence can confuse or hurt the client; a kind explanation is better.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A client in a simulated food-assistance case, ~~who is a single father of three and drives for a delivery app,~~ tells the worker he is being evicted and asks what legal steps to take. ~~The worker has a friend who is a lawyer.~~ What should the worker do?

Target word: act within role **Decides:** Legal advice is outside the worker's role.

A	Camouflage	Uses the friend detail and creates a dual relationship.
B	Adjacent category	Legal advice is outside the worker's scope.
C	Absolute language	Referral is part of the worker's role.
D	Correct	Referral connects him to qualified help.

7. Answer C Concept 5

A 72-year-old client, ~~who used to be a school principal and lives alone with a dog,~~ understands the risks but declines a move to assisted living and prefers home services. There is no immediate danger. The worker believes assisted living is safer. What should the worker do?

Target word: respect choice **Decides:** Competent client, no imminent danger.

A	Dropped element	Drops her capacity to decide for herself.
B	Inverted operation	Overrides a competent client's choice.
C	Correct	Self-determination applies to an informed, competent client.
D	Absolute language	Declining one service does not end the relationship.

8. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

In which situation may a worker act against a competent client's stated wishes?

Target word: reverse: the limit of self-determination **Decides:** Imminent danger is the exception.

A	Absolute language	Worker certainty is not an exception.
B	Adjacent category	A personal preference, not a safety exception.
C	Inverted operation	Declining a service is exactly what self-determination protects.
D	Correct	Imminent danger to self or others limits self-determination.

9. Answer A Concept 6

After a simulated intake at an agency ~~that opened its second site this spring~~, a trainee drafts a case note. The client, ~~a retired carpenter~~, arrived 40 minutes late. Which entry is most appropriate?

Target word: objective note **Decides:** Facts and quotes, not judgments.

A	Correct	Observable facts and a direct quote.
B	Adjacent category	An interpretation without supporting facts.
C	Camouflage	Uses a background detail to guess at motives.
D	Confusion set	A judgment, not an observation.

10. Answer A Concept 6 • transfer

Which case note contains a judgment rather than an objective fact?

Target word: reverse: find the opinion **Decides:** Labels are opinions.

A	Correct	“Hostile” is a label; the note should describe what was said or done.
B	Adjacent category	Factual actions and time.
C	Inverted operation	Objective behavior and a direct quote.
D	Confusion set	A reported statement, recorded as the client’s words.

11. Answer C Concept 7

A client, who enrolled in a parenting program last month ~~and whose sister also attends~~, says she wants to stop coming because it conflicts with her new work schedule. She signed an intake agreement for 12 weeks. What should the worker do?

Target word: withdrawal right **Decides:** Consent can be withdrawn at any time.

A	Dropped element	Drops the informed part of the decision.
B	Camouflage	Uses the sister detail and pressures the client.
C	Correct	Informed consent includes the right to withdraw.
D	Absolute language	A signature does not remove the right to withdraw.

12. Answer C Concept 8

During a planned budgeting session in a simulated case, a client ~~who is a former truck driver~~ says his power was shut off yesterday and he has no heat. It is 20 °F outside and he has a heart condition. ~~The session agenda was set last week.~~ What should the worker address first?

Target word: priority **Decides:** Imminent safety and basic needs come first.

A	Dropped element	Drops the safety risk.
B	Adjacent category	A long-term goal, not the immediate need.
C	Correct	No heat in freezing weather with a heart condition is an immediate risk.
D	Inverted operation	Delays the most urgent need.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Minimum necessary disclosure	Share only the client information needed for the specific purpose, and only with people who need it for that purpose.	Sharing a full file because the requester works in health care too.	A request for client information from a coworker, partner agency, or family member.
2	Mandated reporting	Mandated reporters must report a reasonable suspicion of child or elder abuse or neglect to the proper authority; proof and investigation are not their job.	Waiting for proof or asking the client to confirm details first.	A physical sign or statement that suggests abuse, plus hesitation about certainty.
3	Professional boundaries	Avoid dual relationships and gifts or contacts that blur the helping role; personal social media contact with clients is off-limits.	Thinking a friendly outside relationship builds better rapport.	A client offers a gift, invitation, or friend request.
4	Scope of role and referral	Work within your training and role; refer clients to qualified professionals for needs outside it.	Trying to handle every need personally to keep the client's trust.	A client need such as legal, medical, or clinical counseling help.
5	Client self-determination	Competent clients have the right to make informed choices about their own lives, even ones the worker disagrees with, unless there is imminent danger.	Overriding a client's decision because the worker knows a better option.	A client declines a recommended service.
6	Objective documentation	Record facts: observable behavior, direct quotes, dates, and actions taken — promptly and without personal opinions or labels.	Writing judgments like "uncooperative" or "seems lazy."	Choosing the best case-note entry.
7	Informed consent for services	Clients must understand the service, its purpose, risks, and their right to refuse or withdraw at any time, and agree voluntarily.	Treating a signed intake form as permanent, unquestionable consent.	A client unsure about a program or wanting to stop.
8	Safety first in prioritizing needs	Imminent risk of harm and basic survival needs come before other goals on the service plan.	Following the scheduled agenda when a safety risk appears.	A session agenda interrupted by a safety or basic-needs disclosure.

Course scope (public description): The Health and Human Services Professional Field Experience course provides students with real-world experiences as a health services professional via the virtual world of simulation. The course allows students to conduct their field experience in a variety of different contexts they will find themselves, depending on their professional career choices in the health services' industry. All program coursework leads to this course. This course is eligible for an In Progress grade. Please see the Grading Scale Policy for more information.